

A First Look at Your Project's Size

CS 5388 / CS 4390

Team: Team 9

Project: GPI: Gracias Por Invitar

Work through every step together as a team. Have your Sprint 1 charter open (scope boundary and stakeholder map) and your interview notes. Everything you write here becomes the starting point for today's user stories and for the two estimates in Part 2.

Step 1. List what Release 1 must do *(as a team)*

Start from the “in scope” items in your charter and the strongest needs from your interviews. Write 5 to 8 capabilities as what the system must do, not how. Then mark the hidden work each one will need using the key below.

Hidden work key: T = Testing S = Security or privacy I = Integration with other systems D = Data (collection, cleaning, migration) H = Hosting and deployment U = Usability and accessibility O = Documentation or training

#	Capability (what, not how)	Evidence (charter or interview)	Hidden work
1	An event organizer can upload events on the online platform	Project Charter	U, O, D
2	An event organizer can pay for featured events on the online platform by day and time.	Project Charter	U, O, D, H
3	Show a unified event calendar	Interviews (Phase 2)	T, D, H, U
4	Events goers will be able to subscribe to events based on categories	Interview #	D, U, I
5	The system will show a personalized feed that shows events based on the user's interests	Project Charter	T, D, S
6	The system will show an event feed listed by date	Project Charter	D, U, T
7	A user can save events they want to attend	Interview P2-C3-02	S, D, U
8	An administrator can review and approve a submitted event before it appears publicly	Project Charter (Constraints)	S, D, T, O

The example row is from the fictional Campus Parking System used in lecture.

Step 2. Take the outside view: your own experience *(as a team)*

As a team, pick the most similar thing any of you has built before: a class project, internship feature, hackathon app, or side project.

Question	Answer
What was it?	KASAPro, the internal operations app Samuel built for KASA Contractors: job scheduling, route planning, and pricing. It is the closest match anyone on the team has built, a database-backed web app whose usefulness depends entirely on its records staying accurate and current, which is the same bet GPI is making on event data.
How long was it expected to take?	One month
How long did it take?	Three months
What took longer than expected?	The pricing and routing comparison: the dual unload-site cost comparison with load-type filtering, which carries more rules than anything else in the

Question	Answer
	app. Every new load type changed the comparison, so the logic kept being reworked after it was supposedly done.

Step 3. Take the outside view: similar products *(as a team, web search)*

Divide the searching, then decide together. Find three real products that solve a problem close to yours. Include at least one small product (a startup or an app from a small team) and at least one big product (a large company platform or a government system). For each, find out how long it took to reach its first public release, what went well, and what went wrong.

How to find the timeline and the story

1. Launch announcements, company blogs, and founder interviews often say when building started and when the product first went public.
2. Press coverage, app store version histories, and the Internet Archive's Wayback Machine help confirm first release dates.
3. Postmortems, conference talks, and, for government systems, GAO and Inspector General reports explain what worked and what did not.
4. Measure from the start of development to the first public release, and write down what that first release included. A limited first version and a full launch are different numbers.
5. Every date and figure needs a source you can link. If you cannot find one, write "unknown." AI tools may suggest products to look at, but they are not a source.

Example: a completed entry for a parking product

ParkEasy is fictional. It shows the level of detail to aim for, not real data.

Field	Entry
Product and company	ParkEasy, a four-person startup
Why it is similar	Drivers find and pay for parking from a phone, like our Campus Parking System.
Development started	January 2019 (founder blog post)
First public release	October 2019, in one city only (local news launch story)
Time to first release	About 9 months
What the first release included	A map of open lots and pay-by-phone. No reservations and no monthly permits.
Team size	Three engineers and one designer
What worked	Launching in one city first. Partnering with a single lot operator to get reliable availability data.
What did not work	Their own parking sensors gave bad availability data, so they switched to the operator's feed, adding about 3 months. Payment integration took twice as long as planned.
Sources	Founder blog post (link); local news launch story (link)

What this example tells a team building a parking app: plan for data and payment integration to take the longest, and scope the first release to one location.

Step 3 worksheet: similar products

	Product A (small)	Product B (big)	Product C (big)
Product and company	Upcoming.org, a community event calendar started by Andy Baio as a side project. Bought by Yahoo! in 2005.	Do512.com is the Austin event discovery platform created by the DoStuff media network, run by local teams in 20 cities.	Fever, founder by 4 individuals , is a personalized event discover web platform
Why it is similar to your project	A city-by-city listing of what is happening, so people hear about events before they happen. The same job as GPI, built by one person with no budget.	It serves as a discovery platform that helps people stay up to date with local events and places, which is what GPI will try to achieve.	Initially started as a event discovery for two cities, quickly grew into hundredths of cities/categories/events, matching out interest-based feed.
Development started	January 2003 (notes from Baio's talk "A Tale of Three .Orgs," PDX Web Innovators, 4 June 2008; no Baio-written source for the start date, so treat it as secondhand)	It started in Austin, TX, in 2006. ("Meet Courtney Goforth of Do512", Voyage Houston)	2012, New York, NY
First public release	19 September 2003 (Baio's own launch post on waxy.org)	2006 ("The Story", Do512.com) They founded DoStuff in 2010, which let them expand to more cities. ("Innovation Nation: DoStuff Media", Austin Monthly)	Released in 2014 simultaneously in New York and Madrid
Time to first release	About 9 months, worked nights and mornings around a full-time job. Baio's own verdict: "Rough site launched. Barely functional."	Do512's first release took 1 month after they first came up with the idea. ("Innovation Nation: DoStuff Media", Austin Monthly)	About 2 years.
What the first release included	Anyone could add events they were going to, in fixed categories; see who else was going; browse by metro area; a friends list; RSS feeds. No API, tagging, email or SMS until March 2005.	It started as a website that listed all happy hours around Austin, but it then expanded to include all sorts of events. ("The Story", Do512.com)	Personalized recommendations for entertainment, dining, and cultural events, live in two cities.
Team size, if known	One at launch. Baio kept his day job until the acquisition; two partners joined later.	Two people at first (Jimmy Stewart and Scott Owens) Soon after, they recruited their girlfriends, so it became a team of 4.	4 co-founders at launch

	Product A (small)	Product B (big)	Product C (big)
What worked	Supply came from attendees posting what they were going to, not from promoters. Self-promotion was “banned entirely for its first two years.” A city did not need broad coverage to be useful: “only 2 or 3 individuals” were enough to make a college town work.	• Broadening the scope of the website (including all types of events, not just happy hours). • Dynamic listings • Adding more people to the team • External users (venues, artists, event organizers) could upload and update their own events, that ensured the list was accurate and exhaustive • Partnered with local venues to offer free tickets to users who would RSVP to their events, creating a lot of engagement • Creating their media DoStuff label to be able to use the same technology in other cities	Launching in two major cities (New York & Madrid)
What did not work	After the founders left Yahoo! at the end of 2007, “the social features that made Upcoming unique were minimized, or removed entirely,” and “spam, like creeping kudzu, was left unchecked.” By 2009 “the only people using Upcoming were event promoters and spammers.” A Kickstarter-funded rebuild funded 30 May 2014 did not relaunch until March 2017, about 34 months.	• Having a smaller team of people • Having the scope of the site be so narrow • Static website because it led to inaccuracy and outdated data • The first few years the business was not making money, it took them a few years to gain revenue	Not documentation in the sources found.
Sources (links)	waxy.org/2003/09/upcomingorg_lau/ ; waxy.org/2013/04/the_death_of_upcomingorg/ ; stubborndreams.me/2008/07/31/a-brief-history-of-upcoming-dot-org-by-andy-baio/ ; en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Upcoming	https://www.crunchbase.com/organization/dostuff-media https://voyagehouston.com/interview/meet-courtney-goforth-do512-austin-texas/	https://feverup.com/en/mexico-city https://newsroom.feverup.com/en-AU/about/ https://www.preqin.com/data/profile/asset/fever-labs--inc-/140163

	Product A (small)	Product B (big)	Product C (big)
		https://www.austinmonthly.com/innovation-nation-dostuff-media/ https://do512.com/p/do512s-10-year-anniversary-the-story	

Step 4. Compare *(as a team)*

1. Look at the hidden-work column in Step 1. Which letter appears most often? Did any of your similar products struggle with that same kind of work?

Data (D) appears the most often, which can be seen in all 8 capabilities. Do512 also struggled with static data which led to inaccurate and outdated listings. Upcoming.org also struggled with data quality and moderation, eventually dying out when unmoderated spam ruined the listings.

2. How long did your similar products take to reach a first release, and with how many people? What does that suggest about a first release of your project?

- **Upcoming.org** - Took roughly 9 months for a first release, with only one person.
- **Do512.com** - Took 1 month for the first release. Initially it was a two people, they then recruited two more people.
- **Fever** - About two years for the first release. There was four co-founders for the first release.

Although we deployed a functional baseline website in one week after doing research, our comparables indicate that developing a production-ready first release would take about 6 to 12 months.

3. Name one practice from the “what worked” rows your team will copy, and one mistake from the “what did not work” rows you will avoid.

- **Practice to Copy** - Allow external users and organizers to directly submit and manage event content.
- **Mistake to Avoid**- Avoid static listings since it leads to inaccuracy and outdated data.

Our comparables suggest a first release would take 6 to 12 months with a team of 5.

Keep this sheet. You will use Step 1 to write user stories, and Steps 2 and 3 give you comparators for analogous estimation in Part 2.